

The people you have tried to recruit

The engagement has compiled a list of everyone you have invited to "come and have a go" in the last eighteen months. It runs to forty-three names.

It includes your dad, twice; Lauren's dad, four times; Priya, once, which she has not forgotten; the Hendersons next door; the man who fixed the boiler; the new graduate, on his first morning; a car salesman; a paramedic, while he was working; and the other parents at Mia's swimming lesson, who now sit on the other side of the pool.

Of the forty-three, six came along. Two enjoyed it. One of those two now beats you, and you have stopped inviting him.